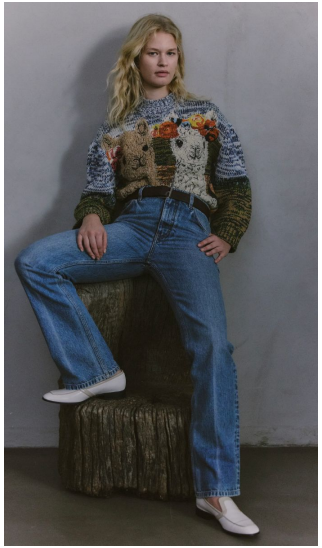
DENIM 2026

For Spring/Summer 2026, runway denim shifted toward refinement rather than rebellion. Designers favored ***clean silhouettes*** such as straight leg, stovepipe, and softly sculpted wide jeans, often styled with tailored jackets and minimal tops. At Prada and Bottega Veneta, denim appeared ***polished and architectural,*** often in light or mid blue washes. Chloé leaned into relaxed volume and soft femininity, pairing denim with fluid blouses. Distressing was subtle, proportions intentional, and styling elegant. Denim is stepping away from Y2K and overly flamboyant styles and into a more modern, versatile, and elevated feeling, positioned as a core ***wardrobe piece*** rather than a trend novelty.

MACRO DENIM TRENDS

STOVEPIPE

A sleek hybrid between straight and slim. An updated take on skinny.



STRAIGHT

Straight leg fits dominated many runway collections. Fit is straight from hip to ankle.

90’S & BARREL

Longer lines and tailored balance than previous season. Can be a little longer or purposefully cropped.

WIDE

Big jeans have never been bigger. Roomy silhouettes with a sense of sophistication

MICRO DENIM TRENDS

LOW-ISH RISE

EMBELLISHMENTS

ELEVATED WASHES

PURPOSEFUL LONG LENGTH

DETAILS AND ATTRIBUTES

SHAPES AND VOLUMES:

01

04

02

03

01 SACAI
02 MM6 MAISON MARGIELA
03 STELLA McCARTNEY
04 CHLOE

FABRICS AND WASHES

There was an emphasize of tactile quality and comfort over rigidity. Designers favored ***softened, lightweight denim*** with a worn in feeling, achieved through ***enzyme washes and gentle finishing.*** While silhouettes appeared clean and structured, fabrics draped naturally and moved with the body. True stretch denim was largely absent, replaced by low-stretch or semi-rigid constructions that balance durability with wearability. Denim looked ***refined yet relaxed***, reinforcing a shift toward longevity, softness, and understated luxury.

A wide range of classic denim washes and colors, from a variety of *whites and off whites through* ***white wash, light wash and very classic mid washes. Bright blues*** also had a place along side ***dark blues***, which we will see dominate in the fall season